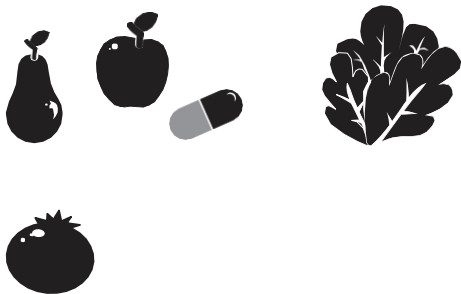




Avoid
Food-
Drug
Interactions





What you eat and drink can affect the way your medicines work. Use this guide to alert you to possible “food-drug interactions” and to help you learn what you can do to prevent them.

In this guide, a food-drug interaction is a change in how a medicine works caused by **food, caffeine, or alcohol**.

A food-drug interaction can:

- prevent a medicine from working the way it should
- cause a side effect from a medicine to get worse or better
- cause a new side effect

A medicine can also change the way your body uses a food. Any of these changes can be harmful.

This guide covers interactions between some common prescription and over-the-counter medicines and food, caffeine, and alcohol. These interactions come from medicine labels that FDA has approved. This guide uses the generic names of medicines, never brand names.

What else can affect how my medicines work?

Your age, weight, and sex; medical conditions; the dose of the medicine; other

medicines; and vitamins, herbals, and other dietary supplements can affect how your medicines work. Every time you use a medicine, carefully follow the information on the label and directions from your doctor or pharmacist.

Does it matter if I take a medicine on a full or empty stomach?

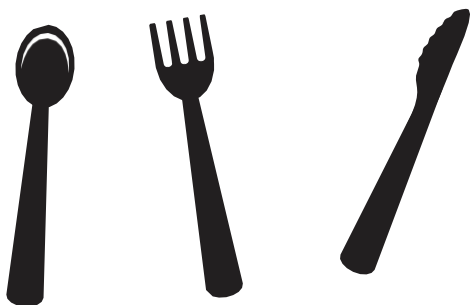
Yes, with some medicines. Some medicines can work faster, slower, better, or worse when you take them on a full or empty stomach. On the other hand, some medicines will upset your stomach, and if there is food in your stomach, that can help reduce the upset. If you don't see directions on your medicine labels, ask your doctor or pharmacist if it is best to take your medicines on an empty stomach (one hour before eating, or two hours after eating), with food, or after a meal (full stomach).

Does it matter if I take my medicine with alcohol?

Yes, the way your medicine works can change when:

- you swallow your medicine with alcohol
- you drink alcohol after you've taken your medicine
- you take your medicine after you've had alcohol to drink

Alcohol can also add to the side effects caused by medicines. You should talk to your doctor about any alcohol you use or plan to use.



How do I know if caffeine is in my food or drinks?

Check the labels on your foods and drinks to see if they have caffeine. Some foods and drinks with caffeine are coffee, cola drinks, teas, chocolate, some high-energy drinks, and other soft drinks. For more about caffeine go to:
www.fda.gov/downloads/UCM200805.pdf

Allergies

Antihistamines

Antihistamines treat or relieve symptoms of colds and allergies, such as sneezing, runny nose, and itchy eyes.
antihistamines can cause drowsiness.

Examples

brompheniramine
cetirizine
chlorpheniramine
clemastine
desloratadine
diphenhydramine
fexofenadine
levocetirizine
triprolidine

Interactions

Alcohol: Avoid alcohol because it can add to any drowsiness caused by these medicines.



Arthritis, Pain, and Fever

Example

acetaminophen

Acetaminophen relieves mild to moderate pain from headaches, muscle aches, toothaches, backaches, menstrual cramps, the common cold, pain of arthritis, and lowers fever.

Interactions

Alcohol:

Acetaminophen can cause liver damage.

Non-Steroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs (NSAIDs)

NSAIDs relieve pain, fever, and inflammation. NSAIDs give short term relief from minor aches and pains from headaches, muscle aches, toothaches, backaches

Examples

aspirin
celecoxib
diclofenac
ibuprofen
ketoprofen
naproxen



Interactions

Food: Take these medicines with food or milk if they upset your stomach.

Alcohol: If you drink three or more alcoholic drinks every day, ask your doctor if you should use medicines

with NSAIDs can cause stomach bleeding .

Asthma

Bronchodilators

Bronchodilators treat and prevent breathing problems from bronchial asthma, chronic bronchitis, relieve wheezing, shortness of breath, troubled breathing, and chest tightness.

Examples

albuterol
theophylline

Interactions

Food: Food can have different effects on different forms of

Caffeine: Using bronchodilators with foods and drinks that have caffeine can increase the chance of side effects, such as excitability, nervousness, and rapid heart beat.

Alcohol: Avoid alcohol if you're using theophylline medicines because alcohol can increase the chance of side effects, such as nausea, vomiting, headache, and irritability.

Cardiovascular Disorders

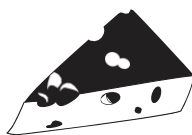
These medicines treat disorders of the cardiovascular system, such as high blood pressure, angina (chest pain), irregular heart beat, heart failure, blood clots, and high cholesterol. Some types of medicines can treat many conditions. For example, beta blockers can treat high blood pressure, angina (chest pain), and irregular heart beats.

ACE Inhibitors (Angiotensin Converting Enzyme Inhibitors)

ACE inhibitors alone or with other medicines lower blood pressure or treat heart failure. They relax blood vessels so blood flows more smoothly and the heart can pump blood better.

Examples

captopril
enalapril
lisinopril
moexipril
quinapril
ramipril



Interactions

Food: Take captopril and moexipril one hour before meals.

ACE inhibitors can increase the amount of potassium in your body. Too much potassium can increase (rapid heart beats). Avoid eating large amounts of foods high in potassium, such as bananas, oranges, green leafy vegetables, and salt substitutes that contain potassium.

Beta Blockers

Beta blockers can be used alone or with other medicines to treat high blood

pressure. They are also used to prevent angina (chest pain) and treat heart attacks.

Don't suddenly stop taking. If you stop a beta blocker suddenly, you can get chest pain

Examples

carvedilol

metoprolol

Interactions

Food: Take carvedilol with food it will lower your blood pressure too much. Take metoprolol with a meal or right after a meal.

Diuretics

Diuretics reduce sodium , so can also treat high blood pressure.

Examples

bumetanide furosemide

hydrochlorothiazide



metolazone
triamterene
triamterene + hydrochlorothiazide

Interactions

Food: Take your diuretic with food if it upsets your stomach.

Some diuretics cause loss of the minerals potassium, calcium, and magnesium from the body.

Glycosides

Glycosides treat heart failure and abnormal heart rhythms.

Example

digoxin

Interactions

Food: Take digoxin one hour before or two hours after eating food. Foods high in fiber may decrease the digoxin in your body, so take digoxin at least two hours before or two hours after eating foods high in fiber (such as bran).

Avoid taking digoxin with senna and decrease the amount and action of digoxin in your body.

Vasodilators-Nitrates

Nitrates prevent or treat chest pain (angina). They work by relaxing the blood vessels to the heart, which improves the blood and oxygen flow to the heart.

Examples

isosorbide dinitrate or mononitrate
nitroglycerin

Interactions

Food: You can take all forms of nitrates on a full or empty stomach.

Alcohol: Avoid alcohol that may low blood pressure.

Antibacterials

Medicines known as antibiotics or antibacterials are used to treat infections caused by bacteria.

Examples

ciprofloxacin

levofloxacin

moxifloxacin



Interactions

Food: You can take ciprofloxacin and moxifloxacin on a full or empty stomach. Take levofloxacin *tablets* on a full or empty stomach. Take levofloxacin *oral solution* one hour before eating or two hours after eating.

Don't take ciprofloxacin with dairy products (like milk and yogurt) or calcium-fortified juices alone, but you can take ciprofloxacin with a meal that has these products in it.

Caffeine: Tell your doctor if you take foods or drinks with caffeine when you take ciprofloxacin, because caffeine may build up in your body.

Metronidazole Antibacterials

Example

metronidazole

Interactions

Alcohol: Don't drink alcohol while taking metronidazole and for at least one full day after finishing the medicine; together alcohol and metronidazole can cause nausea, stomach cramps, vomiting, flushing, and headaches.

Antifungals

Antifungals are medicines that treat or prevent fungal infections. Antifungals work by slowing or stopping the growth of fungi that cause infection.

Examples

fluconazole
itraconazole
posaconazole
voriconazole

griseofulvin
terbinafine



Interactions

Food: Itraconazole *capsules* will work better if you take it during or right after a full meal. Itraconazole *solution* should be taken on an empty stomach. Posaconazole will work better if you take it with a meal, within 20 minutes of eating a full meal, or with a liquid nutritional supplement. Don't mix voriconazole suspension with any other medicines, water, or any other liquid.

Alcohol: Avoid alcohol because griseofulvin can make the side effects :example the heart to beat faster and can cause flushing.

Antiprotozoals

Antiprotozoals treat infections caused by certain protozoa (parasites that can live in your body and can cause diarrhea).

Examples

metronidazole
tinidazole



Interactions

Alcohol: cause nausea, stomach cramps, vomiting, flushing, and headaches
